where else to turn, I violated the sacred rule, the one shining commandment never to be broken, and ran upstairs to Willy's room.

Of course, there was nothing Willy could do. I was just hoping he'd tell me it would be OK, don't freak out, keep calm, Harold. Instead, he laughed like the others. I recall him sitting at his desk, bent over a book, chuckling, while I stood before him fingering the nubs on my newly bare scalp.

Harold, what have you done?

What a question. He sounded like Stewie from *Family Guy.* Wasn't it obvious?

You shouldn't have done it, Harold!

So we're just stating the obvious now?

He said a few more things that were immensely unhelpful and I walked out.

Worse ridicule was yet to come. A few days later, on the front page of the *Daily Mirror,* one of the tabloids, there I was with my new haircut.

Headline: *Harry the Skinhead.*

I couldn't imagine how they'd got wind of the story. A schoolmate must have told someone who told someone who told the papers. They had no photo, thank goodness. But they'd improvised. The image on the front page was a "computer-generated" rendering of the Spare, bald as an egg. A lie. More than a lie, really.

I looked bad, but not that bad.

19.

I DIDN'T THINK it could get worse. What a grievous mistake it is for a member of the Royal Family, when considering the media, to imagine that things can't get worse. Weeks later the same newspaper put me on the front page again.

HARRY'S HAD AN ACCIDENT.

I'd broken a bone in my thumb playing rugby, no big deal, but the paper decided to make out that I was on life support. Bad taste, under any circumstances, but a little more than a year after Mummy's alleged accident?

C'mon, fellas.

I'd dealt with the British press all my life, but they'd never before singled me out. In fact, since Mummy's death an unspoken agreement had governed press treatment of both her sons, and the agreement went like this: *Lay off.*